



Shashank Avvaru

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SUMMARY

Dynamic and results-driven **Senior Project Manager** with over 11 years of experience managing enterprise-scale digital transformation programs across **manufacturing, government, and technology ecosystems**. Skilled in leading cross-functional teams through full project lifecycles from discovery and planning to execution and delivery within structured PMO environments.

Experienced in implementing complex **Product Lifecycle Management (PLM)** solutions, including familiarity with **Teamcenter, ERP integration**, and downstream system alignment. Proven success in balancing **scope, schedule, and budget** while maintaining compliance and stakeholder alignment across global business units.

Adept at applying **Waterfall, Agile, and SAFe methodologies** to deliver high-value outcomes. Hands-on expertise in **risk management, RACI matrix creation, resource forecasting, and change control**. Recognized for leading workshops, facilitating stakeholder decision-making, and ensuring transparent communication across technical and executive audiences.

Strong foundation in **engineering and product development processes, data-driven reporting, and process re-engineering** for enterprise applications. Experienced in developing governance dashboards, managing project budgets exceeding \$5M, and driving measurable improvements in delivery performance, quality assurance, and customer satisfaction.

Certifications include **PMP, SAFe Agilist, and CSM**, with practical knowledge of **Teamcenter PLM, ERP workflows, and product data management (PDM)** integration strategies.

EDUCATION

Master's in computer science – University of Central Missouri, MO	GPA: 3.4/4.0	Aug 2015 – Dec 2016
Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science –JNTU, Hyderabad, India	GPA: 7.0/10.0	Aug 2008 – Mar 2012

EXPERIENCE

United States Department of Agriculture, QA Project Manager	Nov 2018 – Present
Schenck Process LLC, QA/Business Analyst	April 2017 – Dec 2017
Shri Thirumala Enterprises, India, QA/Business Analyst	July 2012 – June 2015

Project Details

United States Department of Agriculture, QA Project Manager	Nov 2018 – Present
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Description:

Quality Management Team is responsible for overseeing FPAC Business Center ISD(FPAC-BC) IT investments through programmatic, technical and functional assessments. This includes providing visibility into the integrity, quality and efficiency of work products and other deliverables that are developed to support the FPAC Business Center ISD(FPAC-BC). Program Management Evaluations, Project Quality Assurance, Governance and Investment Reviews, Decision Gate Reviews, and Business Support Services are the key activities of the Quality Management team.

Responsibilities:

Project Governance & Delivery Leadership

- Led end-to-end project execution across multiple concurrent Salesforce modernization and digital transformation programs aligned with USDA's strategic roadmap and PMO governance.

- Defined project scope, developed charters, and maintained integrated master schedules using MS Project and Jira to track milestones, dependencies, and resource alignment.
- Established and maintained comprehensive RAID (Risks, Assumptions, Issues, and Dependencies) logs to ensure proactive tracking, visibility, and resolution across workstreams.
- Integrated RAID metrics into Power BI dashboards, giving executives real-time visibility into project health and risk exposure.
- Developed standardized RAID templates and governance cadence for portfolio-wide reporting consistency within the PMO.
- Facilitated Agile and SAgE ceremonies (PI Planning, Iteration Reviews, Retrospectives), coordinating over six distributed cross-functional teams.
- Established baselines (CBB, PMB), tracked budgets, and monitored earned value metrics to maintain cost and schedule control.
- Managed hybrid project delivery models combining Agile sprints with milestone-based governance.
- Partnered with PMO leaders to provide weekly status dashboards, executive briefings, and monthly earned value reviews.
- Created detailed RACI matrices to define accountability, ownership, and stakeholder engagement for every deliverable.
- Ensured adherence to PMO frameworks, documentation standards, and compliance checkpoints across all project phases.
- Improved delivery predictability and stakeholder confidence through transparent tracking, proactive governance, and structured escalation management.

Quality Management & IV&V Oversight

- Directed Independent Verification & Validation (IV&V) efforts across design, configuration, testing, and deployment for enterprise applications.
- Implemented a unified Quality Assurance framework combining manual, automated, and API validation to enhance delivery quality.
- Validated all deliverables against contractual baselines, design configurations, and compliance standards using RTM and DCA frameworks.
- Supervised defect triage, change management, and quality gates, reducing production defect recurrence by 20%.
- Integrated testing dashboards in Jira and Azure DevOps, providing live visibility into validation progress and release readiness.
- Partnered with audit and compliance teams to ensure adherence to 21 CFR Part 11 and federal quality standards.

Salesforce Program Management & Automation Strategy

- Managed Salesforce modernization and automation programs, leading design reviews, configuration validation, and readiness checkpoints.
- Oversaw automation through Katalon Studio, Jenkins CI/CD, and Groovy scripting, increasing test coverage from 40% to 85% and reducing manual effort by 50%.
- Coordinated end-to-end testing and third-party API integrations, ensuring seamless cross-system interoperability.
- Established configuration management, data governance, and audit processes for secure platform operations.
- Partnered with data teams and architects to align Salesforce workflows with reporting, analytics, and compliance requirements.

SDET Role – Automation Engineering & Continuous Testing

- Hands-on experience in **functional, regression, API, and performance testing**, using tools like **Cypress, Katalon Studio, Selenium WebDriver, Playwright, and REST Assured**.
- Developed and maintained **automation frameworks** with **Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Groovy, and SQL**, leveraging frameworks such as **TestNG, JUnit, Mocha, Chai, and Cucumber (BDD)** for efficient test coverage.
- Built and integrated **test automation pipelines** into **Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, and Azure DevOps**, driving continuous testing and faster feedback loops.
- Performed **API and load testing** using **Postman, SOAP UI, JMeter, and LoadRunner**, ensuring performance and system reliability under high-load conditions.
- Experience in **Git/GitHub** for version control, **Ansible and Docker** for environment automation and containerization, and **Kubernetes, AWS, and GCP** for cloud-based testing.
- Conducted **cross-browser and cross-platform validation** using BrowserStack and Selenium Grid, ensuring UI consistency and responsiveness.
- Collaborated with developers, testers, and DevOps teams in **Agile/SCRUM environments**, integrating quality checkpoints within every sprint.
- Solid understanding of **software architecture, CI/CD principles, and test-driven development (TDD)** to ensure scalable and maintainable code delivery.

PLM & Teamcenter Implementation Support

- Supported enterprise Product Lifecycle Management (PLM) initiatives integrating Teamcenter with downstream ERP systems.
- Facilitated workshops and process mapping to define data structures, part master governance, and BOM synchronization.
- Partnered with engineering teams to design workflows that improved change management traceability and product release visibility.
- Assisted in system validation and configuration walkthroughs ensuring readiness and compliance alignment.
- Documented system dependencies, configuration requirements, and test scenarios for deployment validation.

Key Achievements

- Delivered multiple enterprise releases under budget with over 95% of milestones achieved on time.
- Improved UAT defect closure rate by 25%, accelerating deployment readiness.
- Reduced testing time regression by 50% and decreased post-release issues by 20% through automation and proactive governance.
- Designed and implemented an integrated RAID governance model, improving executive reporting and portfolio risk visibility.
- Developed real-time Power BI dashboards for schedule tracking, budget variance, and KPI visualization.

Schenck Process LLC, Product Owner

April 2017 – Dec 2017

Description:

Create Business Requirement based on Product Development Process Assessment. PDPAs include interviewing various departments to learn current processes their effectively, pains and potential to fail or improve.

Responsibilities:

- Collaborated with stakeholders, SMEs, and leadership to define product vision, roadmap, and release strategy, ensuring alignment with business goals and KPIs.
- Partnered with technical teams to translate business needs into clear user stories and acceptance criteria, managing a prioritized backlog of features and enhancements.
- Conducted Product Development Process Assessments (PDPAs) to identify inefficiencies, define KPIs, and drive continuous improvement across engineering, QA, and support.
- Facilitated Agile ceremonies including sprint planning, backlog refinement, retrospectives, and iteration reviews, ensuring value-driven delivery and team alignment.
- Defined and maintained epics, features, and stories in JIRA; tracked sprint velocity, burn-down charts, and delivery metrics to monitor progress.
- Performed market and competitive analysis to inform product roadmap and identify feature differentiators.
- Developed business workflow diagrams, process models, and use-case scenarios to visualize and validate end-to-end solutions.
- Partnered with QA and engineering teams to define test strategy, UAT criteria, and release readiness standards ensuring quality delivery.
- Conducted GAP, Cost/Benefit, and SWOT analyses to support prioritization decisions and justify investments.
- Collaborated with developers and architects to ensure scalability, performance, and compliance of technical solutions.
- Supported cross-platform integrations (Salesforce, ERP, POS, and API ecosystems) to ensure consistent data flow and operational efficiency.
- Championed data-driven decision making, using analytics dashboards to monitor adoption, performance, and customer satisfaction metrics.
- Built and delivered executive reports, dashboards, and product health summaries, communicating progress and ROI to leadership.
- Ensured governance, compliance, and documentation standards were met across all product releases.
- Acted as voice of the customer (VoC) continuously gathering feedback, evaluating usability, and driving UX enhancements.
- Fostered collaboration between Product, Engineering, and Design teams, ensuring shared ownership of outcomes and innovation.
- Supported AI and automation initiatives, applying generative insights and prompt engineering to optimize user engagement and reporting capabilities.
- Advocated for continuous improvement culture by mentoring junior BAs and Scrum team members on Agile best practices and product ownership discipline.

Shri Thirumala Enterprises, India, Business Analyst

July 2012 – June 2015

Description:

The project was to develop an analytical reporting building application about consumer behavior, product trend analysis and predictive model for Retail and FMCG domains.

Responsibilities:

- Defined and executed end-to-end test strategies for web and mobile applications, covering functional, regression, integration, and API testing across Agile product teams.
- Designed and maintained manual test cases aligned with business requirements, user stories, and acceptance criteria; ensured full coverage of critical workflows.
- Developed and executed Selenium-based automation scripts using Java and TestNG to validate core product functionality and reduce manual effort.
- Built modular, reusable automation components and maintained regression test suites, ensuring stability across releases and minimizing false positives.
- Integrated automated test suites into CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins and GitHub Actions, enabling continuous testing and early defect detection.
- Performed API testing using Postman and REST Assured to validate backend services, authentication flows, and data integrity.
- Conducted cross-browser and cross-platform testing using Selenium Grid and cloud platforms like Browser Stack to ensure consistent user experience.
- Applied advanced scripting techniques include dynamic waits, XPath/CSS selectors, and custom assertions to enhance test reliability.
- Defined and tracked testing timelines, aligning QA milestones with sprint goals, release schedules, and production deployment windows.
- Delivered daily QA status updates, weekly dashboards, and monthly performance reports to product and engineering leadership, highlighting test coverage, defect trends, resource utilization, and release readiness.
- Created release readiness reports summarizing test execution, open defects, risk assessments, and go/no-go recommendations.
- Integrated test results with JIRA, TestRail, and Confluence, maintaining real-time visibility into test execution, defect status, and traceability to requirements.
- Partnered with Product Managers and stakeholders to gather, analyze, and document business requirements and user needs.
- Translated business goals into clear, testable user stories and acceptance criteria; maintained Requirement Traceability Matrix (RTM) for full coverage and compliance.
- Conducted gap analysis and impact assessments for new features, change requests, and product enhancements.
- Facilitated UAT sessions with internal teams and clients, capturing feedback and validating business objectives.
- Supported backlog grooming and sprint planning by evaluating business value, technical feasibility, and customer impact.
- Managed QA resources, including task allocation, workload balancing, and mentoring junior testers on automation and analysis best practices.
- Acted as a liaison between technical teams and business stakeholders to ensure shared understanding of product goals and quality expectations.
- Contributed to Agile ceremonies including sprint planning, daily stand-ups, retrospectives, and product demos.
- Advocated for the end-user experience and long-term maintainability through proactive quality planning and cross-functional collaboration.

CERTIFICATIONS:

- CSM (Certified Scrum Master)
- SAgile (Scaled Agile Framework) Agilist
- Salesforce Admin
- PMP